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■ A protester waves a Palestinian flag as people demonstrate in front of a cruise ship carrying Israeli tourists as it tries to approach the Aegean Sea island of Syros, Greece, on Tuesday.

More than 100 NGOs warn ‘mass starvation’ spreading across Gaza

Israel is facing mounting pressure over humanitarian situation in the Strip

JERUSALEM

More than 100 aid organisations warned yesterday that “mass starvation” was spreading across the Gaza Strip and that their own colleagues were suffering acutely from the shortages.

In a statement, the 111 signatories — including Doctors Without Borders (MSF), Save the Children and Oxfam — warned that “our colleagues and those we serve are wasting away”.

“As the Israeli government’s siege starves the people of Gaza, aid workers are now joining the same food lines,

The groups called for an immediate negotiated ceasefire, the opening of all land crossings and the free flow of aid through UN-led mechanisms.

risking being shot just to feed their families,” the statement read.

The groups called for an immediate negotiated ceasefire, the opening of all land crossings and the free flow of aid through UN-led mechanisms.

Israel is facing mounting international pressure over the catastrophic humanitarian situation in the Palestinian territory, where more than two million people have endured 21 months of devastating conflict.

In their statement, the humanitarian organisations said that warehouses with tonnes of supplies were sitting untouched just outside the territory, and even inside, as they were blocked from accessing or delivering the goods.

Cycle of hope, heartbreak

“Palestinians are trapped in a cycle of hope and heartbreak, waiting for assistance and ceasefires, only to wake up to worsening conditions,” the signatories said.

“It is not just physical torment, but psychological. Survival is dangled like a mirage,” they added. “The humanitarian system cannot run on false promises. Humanitarians cannot operate on shifting time-lines or wait for political commitments that fail to deliver access.”

— AFP
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ICJ rules failure to act on climate change violates law

UN top court gives landmark verdict on nations’ obligations to tackle climate change

THE HAGUE

The United Nations’ top court announced yesterday that if countries fail to take measures to protect the planet from climate change, they could be in violation of international law.

The International Court of Justice was delivering an advisory opinion in a landmark case about nations’ obligations to tackle climate change and the consequences they may face if they don’t, calling it an “urgent and existential” threat to humanity.

Turning point

“Failure of a state to take appropriate action to protect the climate system ... may constitute an internationally wrongful act,” court President Yuji Iwasawa said during the hearing.

The non-binding opinion,

130 countries have backed case led by Vanuatu

which runs to over 500 pages, is seen as a potential turning point in international climate law.

The court also said a “clean, healthy and sustainable environment” is a human right. Enshrining a sustainable environment as a human right paves the way for other legal actions, including states returning to the ICJ to hold each other to account as well as domestic lawsuits, along with legal instruments like investment agreements.

The case is led by the Pacific island nation of Vanuatu and backed by more than 130 countries.

All UN member states including major greenhouse gas emitters like the United States and China are parties to the court.

— AP

Dubai residents must clear traffic fines to renew visas

NEW ELECTRONIC SYSTEM LINKS RESIDENCY WITH FINES

DUBAI

BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Residents in Dubai will no longer be able to renew their residency visas if they have outstanding traffic fines, the emirate’s top immigration official said.

The General Directorate of Residency and Foreigners Affairs (GDRFA) in Dubai has announced the implementation of a new electronic system that links residency-related transactions with the Dubai Police Traffic Fines System.

Under the new system, residents must settle all outstanding traffic fines before proceeding with any residency renewal, cancellation or transfer requests.

Pilot phase

During a media briefing held yesterday, the GDRFA confirmed that the electronic linkage is currently in a pilot phase and applies to individuals applying for the renewal, cancellation, or transfer of their residency.

The authority clarified that no residency renewal, status modification, or cancellation requests



We are doing everything for the residents. Live here, follow the rules. If the traffic fine is a big amount, they can pay in instalments. We are not making it hard for people.”

Lt Gen Mohammad Ahmad Al Marri

submitted from within the UAE will be accepted unless all traffic fines have been cleared.

Lieutenant General Mohammad Ahmad Al Marri, Director-General of GDRFA Dubai, urged residents to respect local laws and take responsibility for pending penalties. “We are doing everything for the residents. Live here, follow the rules,” said Al Marri. “If the traffic fine is a big amount, they can pay in instalments. We are not making it hard for people.”

The GDRFA chief said the policy is not intended to burden residents but to ensure everyone respects the law. “If you like to

live in the country in a good way, following the rules, respecting the country, follow the rules of the country. We don’t have to force anyone to come and pay.”

Process after job loss

Al Marri also said individuals must strictly follow immigration laws, even during periods of employment uncertainty. “If you follow the rules, no one will question you why you didn’t renew your residency visa. Nobody will come and ask you why you are overstaying,” he told reporters. “You say: ‘I lost my job here and I’m trying for another one.’ Okay, you try, but when you lose your job, there is a system.”

He clarified that once someone loses their job, they must exit the country and search for a new job from abroad before returning to the UAE.

The GDRFA also successfully processed more than 52,000 instant video calls during the first six months of 2025. The Instant Video Call service enables real-time communication between residents and GDRFA employees, allowing users to complete a wide range of transactions without the need to visit customer service centres in person.

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